

Nikolas Astra

IT Support / Software Development

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with hands-on experience diagnosing and resolving hardware, software, and network issues across Mac and Windows environments. Builds, upgrades, and repairs computer systems and configures and troubleshoots networks at a component level. Full-stack development background adds a deeper technical grounding, translating into faster root-cause diagnosis and the ability to communicate complex technical issues clearly to non-technical users. Fast, self-directed learner who ramps quickly on new systems, tools, and environments.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Hardware & Peripherals: PC/laptop assembly, upgrades & repair, component-level diagnostics, workstation setup and configuration

Operating Systems: Windows, macOS, Linux — support, troubleshooting, and installation/configuration

Networking: Network setup, router/connectivity troubleshooting, device configuration

Front-End: JavaScript, React, Next.js, HTML, CSS, UI/UX, GSAP, Shopify Liquid

Back-End: Node.js, Express

Databases: MongoDB, Mongoose, PostgreSQL

APIs & Auth: REST APIs, JSON, Axios, JWT, bcrypt

Payments: Stripe.js, PayPal

State & UI: Redux Toolkit, Swiper, Bootstrap

Tools: Git, npm, Yarn, Command Line

Other Languages: Python, C++, C#

Design & Creative: Adobe Creative Suite, TouchDesigner, Fusion 360

Soft Skills: Technical troubleshooting under pressure, clear communication with non-technical users, documentation, cross-functional collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer (Product & Back-End Focus) — [Variable Z](#) — Los Angeles, CA

2021 – Present

- Debug and maintain a live, customer-facing production platform handling real transactions, resolving issues across front-end, back-end, and third-party integrations (Stripe, PayPal).
- Diagnose and resolve issues in authentication, order processing, and payment systems, identifying root causes and deploying fixes with minimal disruption.
- Manage releases and deployments, applying structured testing and troubleshooting to maintain platform stability.

Freelance Full-Stack Developer — Remote

2020 – Present

- Deliver direct technical support to clients — gathering requirements, diagnosing issues, and explaining solutions in plain, non-technical language.
- Coordinate deployments and manage shared codebases using Git-based workflows.
- Resolve ongoing technical and performance issues across multiple client projects.

UI Developer — SeePoint, LLC — Redondo Beach, CA

2019 – 2021

- Maintained and troubleshooted the company e-commerce website, resolving functional issues to keep the site running reliably.
- Developed and supported UI components for kiosk-based hardware systems, working at the intersection of hardware and software.

Computer Lab Technician — Woodbury University — Burbank, CA

2016 – 2018

- Delivered front-line technical support across Mac and Windows environments in a high-traffic computer lab, resolving hardware, software, and network issues for students and staff.
- Diagnosed and triaged technical problems under time pressure, prioritizing issues to minimize user downtime.
- Maintained lab hardware and systems to ensure consistent uptime and reliability.

Interactive Design Intern — VirtuLabs — San Francisco, CA

2017

- Integrated software with physical hardware systems for a live public installation (Project SkyLights, Digital Design Days + O FFF Milano), resolving real-time technical issues in a production setting.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

Woodbury University — Burbank, CA